

The other incident occurred maybe two days ago when a fuel truck exploded in a town market. We were not able to determine the cause of the explosion, and—as you can imagine—the speculation is wild. The bottom line is that the tanker cast off chunks of scrap metal and shrapnel as it exploded injuring two children. One, a 14 year old boy, took a large chunk of shrapnel to the head. It entered his brain from behind and came out the front. Despite our best efforts, including evacuating him to a brain surgeon, he died from his injuries. The second child was hit in the arm and is fine now. That is the funny thing about these tragedies: there is no rhyme or reason to who is hurt, who dies, or who lives. Its all completely random.

That is enough morbid story-telling for now. The truth is that despite the destruction all around, I have remained fairly sheltered. I choose not to rush out and look at the casualties, but choose instead to stand my post here in the TOC. I wish I knew when we were coming home. I miss you and Mason very much.

Love,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Christian", with a long horizontal flourish extending to the right.

Christian